

Saturday, 15 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

28° 21°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

24° 16°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

22° 15°

GLASGOW

Overcast

18° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 Nigel Farage has easily won the Clacton by-election, but his absence after the result has raised questions.

The Reform UK leader was nowhere to be seen following his expected victory. Political commentators are now debating what this unorthodox win means for his party and future.

POLITICS · UK

2 A woman has been cleared of owning an XL bully dog that fatally bit a man.

Chanel Fong's partner's father, Keven Jones, tragically died from severe blood loss after being bitten on the leg. The verdict comes amid ongoing debate about dog control laws.

LAW · UK

3 A vital NHS service has admitted to a data breach caused by its use of pagers.

The medical data of transplant patients from across the UK was sent over an unencrypted pager network. This raises serious concerns about patient confidentiality and outdated technology.

HEALTH · UK

4 The UK heatwave is coming to an end for many today, with cooler weather expected for the weekend.

Heatwave conditions have continued in south-east England on Friday. However, temperatures are set to drop significantly across the country as we head into Saturday.

WEATHER · UK

5 Fire crews have been battling widespread blazes across the West Midlands, with houses destroyed in Stourbridge.

Multiple fires tore through the region on Thursday, causing what witnesses described as 'carnage'. Firefighters are still working to bring the incidents under control.

EMERGENCY · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Eurovision organisers are reportedly proposing new rules to try and reduce political voting.**
They say politically motivated voting is 'persistent' and 'deeply worrying'. It will be interesting to see if these new measures can truly make a difference to the contest.
ON AIR – Do you think political voting is a big problem at Eurovision, or is it just part of the fun?
MUSIC · FUTURE
- 2 The One Show's Alex Jones has shared a lovely memory of meeting Dolly Parton without her usual glam.**
Alex recalled how the country music legend was 'absolutely striking' even without make-up or a wig. It sounds like a truly memorable encounter for The One Show host.
ON AIR – Who is the most surprising celebrity you've ever seen without their usual 'look'?
TV · NOW
- 3 One fan is taking their love for movies to the next level, sharing their flat with a 6ft Terminator.**
Martin's one-bedroom flat is also home to over 30 other film props. It sounds like quite the unique living arrangement!
ON AIR – What's the most unusual item you've ever collected or displayed in your home?
FILM · NOW
- 4 This weekend marks the 40th anniversary of Queen's last performance with Freddie Mercury.**
The iconic show took place in Knebworth, making it a significant date for rock fans. It's a moment in music history that still resonates with many.
ON AIR – What's your favourite Queen song, and why does it mean something to you?
MUSIC · NOW
- 5 The world's biggest YouTuber, MrBeast, has announced he has married Thea Booyesen.**
He shared the happy news, saying he had finally found his 'Mrs Beast'. Congratulations to the happy couple!
ON AIR – Do you follow any YouTubers, and what kind of content do you enjoy watching?
ONLINE · NOW

On the schedule

1

Celtic midfielder Arne Engels is reportedly set for a transfer to West Ham United.

The Belgium international is currently undergoing a medical, according to Celtic manager Martin O'Neill. This would be a big move for the young player.

ON AIR – West Ham fans, are you excited about the prospect of Engels joining the squad?

FOOTBALL · UK

2

Free agent Jadon Sancho is reportedly favouring a move abroad, despite offers from Premier League clubs.

The winger's future has been a big talking point this summer. It seems he might be looking for a new challenge outside of England.

ON AIR – Where do you think Sancho would thrive the most if he moves abroad?

FOOTBALL · UK

3

Ukrainian club Shakhtar Donetsk are hoping to play their Champions League home games at Chelsea's Stamford Bridge.

This would offer them a secure venue for their European fixtures. It's a big request, and we'll see if it comes to fruition.

ON AIR – Do you think Chelsea should open their doors to Shakhtar Donetsk for their Champions League matches?

FOOTBALL · UK

4

Great Britain's Amy Hunt has secured her second European Championships gold medal in the women's 200m.

She charged to victory in Birmingham, beating Rhasidat Adeleke and Dina Asher-Smith. Hunt now has her sights set on a historic quadruple!

ON AIR – How impressive is Amy Hunt's performance, and do you think she can achieve that historic quadruple?

ATHLETICS · UK

5

Iga Swiatek has clinched her first WTA title of the season, winning the Canadian Open in Toronto.

She secured a straight-set victory over Elena Rybakina in the final. It's a strong return to form for the tennis star.

ON AIR – Who is your favourite female tennis player, and why do you enjoy watching them?

TENNIS · GLOBAL

Quick hits

- 1 The enduring appeal of board games is seeing a delightful resurgence in living rooms across the nation.**
Families and friends are rediscovering the joy of unplugged entertainment, gathering around the kitchen table for classic and new board game challenges. It's a lovely way to connect and create shared memories, away from screens.
- 2 Crafting enthusiasts are embracing the charm of 'upcycled book art', transforming old novels into beautiful decorative pieces.**
From intricate paper sculptures to folded book landscapes, these creative projects give beloved but no longer read books a wonderful new lease of life. It's a sustainable and artistic hobby.
- 3 New research suggests that the gentle rhythm of 'knitting or crocheting' can significantly reduce stress and improve focus.**
The repetitive, meditative motions involved in these textile crafts are proving to be a fantastic way to unwind after a busy day. Many are finding it a very mindful activity.
- 4 The comforting tradition of 'afternoon tea' is experiencing a wonderful revival, from grand hotels to local cafes.**
People are treating themselves to delicate sandwiches, scones with jam and cream, and a pot of their favourite brew. It's a lovely excuse to slow down and enjoy a bit of indulgence.
- 5 Community gardens are flourishing, with more people than ever getting their hands dirty to grow local produce together.**
These shared green spaces are not only providing fresh fruit and vegetables but also fostering strong neighbourhood bonds. It's a truly wholesome activity for all ages.
- 6 The simple pleasure of 'reading a physical map' is making a quirky comeback, especially for road trippers and hikers.**
There's a certain satisfaction in unfolding a large map and tracing your route, rather than relying solely on satellite navigation. It adds a touch of adventure to any journey.
- 7 A charming trend for 'local history walking tours' is captivating residents and visitors alike.**
These guided strolls reveal the hidden stories and fascinating past of our towns and villages, often unearthing surprising facts about familiar streets. It's a wonderful way to connect with your local heritage.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out if something in the fridge is still good to eat, even if it looks a bit dubious?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A QUICK SNIFF, OFTEN WHILST HOLDING OUR BREATH!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh hot cross bun. What is it?

ANSWER: CAREFULLY CHECKING FOR THE PERFECT AMOUNT OF FRUIT IN EACH BITE.

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those 'unseen skills' or quirky talents we possess that might not be useful in everyday life, but are surprisingly impressive to others.**

Perhaps you can juggle an odd number of items, recite the alphabet backwards, or identify obscure bird calls? What's your secret, slightly silly, special ability?

- **Think about a 'small act of kindness' you once received from a complete stranger that really brightened your day and stayed with you.**

Was it someone holding a door, letting you go first in a queue, or offering a kind word? What small gesture made a big difference?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that the 'smell of rain' actually has a name? It's called Petrichor, and it's caused by an oil secreted by certain plants, combined with a chemical compound from soil bacteria.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A team of researchers once taught a flock of pigeons to play a very simple game of noughts and crosses, and they even developed their own winning strategies.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The distinctive 'red telephone box' was designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott, who also designed Liverpool Cathedral.
- Bananas are berries, but strawberries are not.
- The world's first underground railway, the Metropolitan Railway, opened in London in 1863.
- A 'bibliosmia' is the enjoyment of the smell of old books.
- Australia is wider than the Moon.
- The longest place name in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlantysiliogogoch, in Wales.
- Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.
- The humble 'pencil' can draw a line about 35 miles long and write approximately 45,000 words.

On this day

Day 227 of the year, 138 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Poland); Christian feast day: Altfrid; Christian feast day: Alypius of Thagaste; Christian feast day: Feast day of the Assumption of Mary, one of the Catholic holy days of obligation (a public holiday in Austria, Belgium, Benin, Bosnia, Burundi, Cameroon, Chile, Colombia, Croatia, Cyprus, France, some states in Germany, Greece, Guatemala, Italy, Ivory Coast, Lebanon, Liechtenstein, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Madagascar, Malta, Mauritius, Paraguay, Poland, Portugal, Romania, Senegal, Seychelles, Slovenia, Spain, Switzerland, Togo, and Vanuatu); and its related observances: Feast of the Dormition of the Theotokos (Eastern Orthodox, Oriental Orthodox and Eastern Catholic Churches). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1972 — Ben Affleck, American actor and filmmaker
- 1948 — Tom Johnston, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1985 — Nipsey Hussle, American rapper (died 2019)
- 1938 — Stix Hooper, American jazz drummer
- 1958 — Rondell Sheridan, American actor and comedian
- 1933 — Bobby Helms, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 1997)
- 1946 — Jimmy Webb, American singer-songwriter and pianist
- 1950 — Tess Harper, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 2025 — US president Donald Trump meets with Russian president Vladimir Putin in Alaska, the first such summit since the 2022 Russian invasion of Ukraine.
- 2020 — Russia begins production on the Sputnik V COVID-19 vaccine.
- 2021 — Kabul falls into the hands of the Taliban as Ashraf Ghani flees Afghanistan along with local residents and foreign nationals, effectively reestablishing the Islamic Emirate of Afghanistan.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1882 — Start of the second part of the Montceau-les-Mines troubles by the Black Band, groups of anarchist miners.
- 1995 — In South Carolina, Shannon Faulkner becomes the first female cadet matriculated at The Citadel (she drops out less than a week later).

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2021 — Kabul falls into the hands of the Taliban as Ashraf Ghani flees Afghanistan along with local residents and foreign nationals, effectively reestablishing the Islamic Emirate of Afghanistan.
- 2007 — An 8.0-magnitude earthquake off the Pacific coast devastates Ica and various regions of Peru killing 514 and injuring 1,090.
- 1998 — Northern Ireland: Omagh bombing takes place; 29 people (including a woman pregnant with twins) killed and some 220 others injured.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 228 of the year, 137 days left in 2026. Today Bennington Battle Day (Vermont, United States); Children's Day (Paraguay); Christian feast day: Ana Petra Pérez Florido; Christian feast day: Armel (Armagillus). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1997 — Greyson Chance, American musician
- 1993 — Cameron Monaghan, American actor and model
- 1962 — Steve Carell, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1948 — Joey Spampinato, American singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1980 — Vanessa Carlton, American singer-songwriter
- 1942 — Robert Squirrel Lester, American soul singer (died 2010)
- 1957 — Laura Innes, American actress and director
- 1979 — Paul Gallacher, Scottish footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2015 — Trigana Air Flight 267, an ATR 42, crashes in Oksibil, Bintang Mountains Regency, killing all 54 people on board.
- 1960 — Cyprus gains its independence from the United Kingdom.
- 2005 — West Caribbean Airways Flight 708, a McDonnell Douglas MD-82, crashes in Machiques, Venezuela, killing all 160 people on board.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1975 — Australian Prime Minister Gough Whitlam symbolically hands over land to the Gurindji people after the eight-year Wave Hill walk-off, a landmark event in the history of Indigenous land rights in Australia, commemorated in a 1991 song by Paul Kelly and an annual celebration.
- 2008 — The Trump International Hotel and Tower in Chicago is topped off at 1,389 feet (423 m), at the time becoming the world's highest residence above ground-level.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

SAT 15 Premier League season begins (2026/27)

22–23 Belgian Grand Prix (F1)